

EASTER EGGS



Easter Eggs are undocumented, hidden tidbits in software, games, etc., that users accidentally stumble upon. These are fun to find, and thousands have already been documented.

Easter eggs started out as a rebellion by early programmers who did not get credit for their work. That's why some of them are as simple as a scrolling list of programmers. However, you also find some as advanced as a hidden car racing game in Excel 2000. So read on to explore the amusing world of Easter eggs.

Windows XP

Unexpected shutdown

For this, you need a software called Resource Hacker. Get it from our July 2004 Mindware CD, or download it from <http://www.users.on.net/~johnson/resource-hacker/>. Resource Hacker is a free tool to view and modify

32-bit Windows executables and resource files.

Open the msgina.dll file, located in the `C:\Windows`



Resource Hacker is a handy tool to find out what's hidden inside Windows System files.

`\System32` directory, in Resource Hacker. In the left pane, expand `Dialog > 2210 > 1033`. A dialog box opens at the bottom right hand of the screen. Notice the line just below the drop-down list

entitled 'Why did the computer shut down unexpectedly?!'

Solitaire Win Win

Force Solitaire to win by a hack. Here's how: Open `sol.exe` located in `C:\Windows\System32\` using Resource Hacker. Expand `String Table > 64 > 1033` in the left pane. Notice a line in the right pane saying 1010, "Force a win". Use these numbers to enable the Easter Egg. Now expand `Menu > 1 > 1033`. Create a menu by typing the following just before the last closing brace: `POPUP "&Easter Egg"`

```
{
  MENUITEM "&Egg 1", 1008
  MENUITEM "&Egg 2", 1009
  MENUITEM "&Egg 3", 1010
}
```

Now, click the Compile Script button. Next, go to `File > Save` and save it in the original location, i.e., `C:\Windows\System32\sol.exe`. Also, replace `sol.exe` in the `C:\Windows\System32\dllcache` folder. Now, a new menu Easter Egg appears with Egg 1, Egg 2 and Egg 3 as options. Click Egg 3 to force a win.

WinRAR

Falling Book

Works on: WinRAR 3.20, 3.30

WinRAR—the popular file compression utility—has a smart Easter Egg. Start

WinRAR and go to `Help > About`. Next, click the book icon and it starts to fall. Further, if you press and hold `[Shift]`, and click the logo, you see a small sail boat near the letter 'R'. You may have to click a few times to see it, though.

Winamp

Full Screen Credits

Works on: Winamp 2.91

Start Winamp, go to Winamp menu, click Nullsoft Winamp and switch to the Credits tab to see an animated screen. Now, hold down `[Ctrl] + [Alt]` and right-click twice on the animation. This changes it to full-screen mode and alters the animation a bit. Repeat the same step to get back to normal mode. This full-screen animation depends on the active visualisation. Change it to spectrum and then oscilloscope and repeat the process to see the difference.

Full Screen Credits

Works On: Winamp 5

An animated logo comes up as you go to `Winamp menu > Nullsoft Winamp` and click the Winamp tab. Press and hold `[Shift]` and double-click on this logo to change it to an ASCII art.

Dancing Llamas

Works On: Winamp 5

This is one amusing egg in Winamp 5. First play a song with fast beats and heavy bass. Now, switch to the modern skin and resize the main window. Increase its width to make the Beat



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